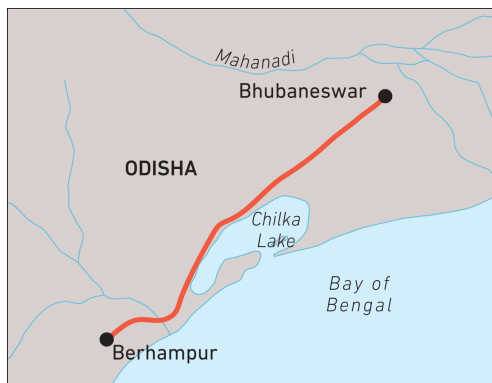

AROUND THE LAKE

Konark Express, *Bhubaneswar–Brahmapur*



Asia's largest saltwater lagoon, the Chilika Lake is spread across 1,100 sq km and is situated in the eastern state of Odisha. A favourite with birdwatchers, it is one of the largest breeding grounds for flamingoes. Dotted with small islands, salt pans, and fisheries, the spectacular lake is equally impressive from a train window. Fast trains take 15 minutes to pass the lake,

offering stunning views of the lagoon, the never-ending expanse of water, some with the fields in the foreground, and bamboo boundaries marking the fishing areas. Certain trains run right along the lake, so keep an eye out for the moment when the track curves to catch a glimpse of the locomotive as it turns.



Chilika Lake, Odisha